

NOT HERE — The Sixth Bar: Audition Brief

Three candidate variants for the Act 3 composition finale · prepared for the listening session required by design/act3-plan.md §Cues, item 1 — no scene prose hardens around a variant until it is approved.

Where this sits

The Foghorn Song is six bars in D dorian, 6/8; bar 6 has always been a rest. Bar 5 — Sam's run — ends hanging on **E**, the **2nd degree**, over Barb's Am chord: it wants D and has never got it. In the finale the player composes the sixth bar, and the no-key game selects the notated variant by the Night-1 intake answer (n1: goodbye) — the interview literally composes your bar. Per Ruling 3, the only sixth bar ever rendered in any ending is the player's; Wren's own ending stays unheard. Each candidate renders solo on guitar and in context — bars 1–5 as shipped, the candidate answering in bar 6 over the sea and the horn's low D drone. In this pass the sixth bar is framed to be unmistakable: the sea's swell pattern skips bar 6 so the bar opens out of a hush, the drone bows out at the downbeat and re-enters softly underneath, the guitar is brought forward in the mix, and each variant gets the only sixth-bar harmony the song has ever had — 'never' on the ii triad it climbs, 'forgot' on bar 1's Dm cut off where the memory fails, 'door' on bar 1's Dm held the full bar.

The three candidate sixth bars, each shown after bar 5's hanging E

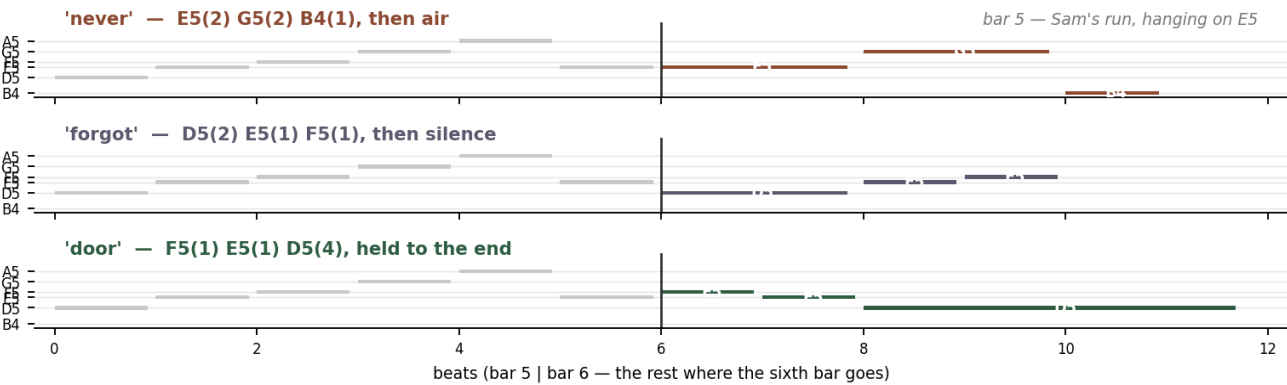


Figure 1 — Pitch content of each candidate (coloured) following bar 5 (grey). Beats are eighth notes; the bar line marks the rest where the sixth bar goes.

The candidates side by side

Variant	Night-1 answer	What the bar does	Dramatic reading	Audition files
'door'	"I said it to the door."	F5–E5–D5 held four beats. The only variant that resolves: it finishes bar 1's D–E–F–E arch with the first D the melody has ever been given.	You said goodbye to something, once. Your bar gets to cadence — completion as self-erasure; the gift that only costs everything.	sixthbar-door.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-door-context.wav (28.5 s)
'never'	"No. I never do."	E5–G5–B4, then air. Climbs the ii triad — the chord that most wants to lead home — and abandons it on the dorian question-note. No D anywhere; no cadence.	For the one who never says goodbye: the bar ends without cadence, with air left in it — the same refusal the horn has made for seven years.	sixthbar-never.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-never-context.wav (28.5 s)
'forgot'	"I don't remember leaving it."	D5–E5–F5, then two silent beats. Quotes bar 1's opening at pitch, then the memory fails on its peak note — the F cut to a single fading beat, and nothing after.	For the one who can't remember leaving: the tune starts to come back and doesn't. The break is the biography.	sixthbar-forgot.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-forgot-context.wav (28.5 s)

What to listen for

- 1. The hand-off.** In each context render, bar 5's hanging E should feel like a question the candidate answers — or pointedly refuses to. 'door' should land like a held breath let go; 'never' like a sentence interrupted politely; 'forgot' like a radio losing the station.
- 2. The voice.** The candidate enters on guitar, forward in the mix against the town's music box — it should read as a *person answering a music box*, not a new verse of the same tune.
- 3. The hush.** The sea skips its bar-6 swell and the horn's drone bows out at the downbeat, re-entering softly underneath — the bar should feel held up in air, not washed over. Only 'door' fully agrees with the low D; 'never' and 'forgot' should audibly withhold that agreement.
- 4. The chord.** Each variant carries its own bar-6 harmonium chord: ii for 'never' (leading nowhere), bar 1's Dm cut short for 'forgot' (the harmony forgets too), bar 1's Dm held the full bar for 'door' (the resolution the tune has waited for).

5. Tempo feel. 144 bpm eighth-note pulse — slow, tidal. If a candidate feels rushed, the fault is the render, not the notes.

Decision requested: approve each variant (or send it back) so Act 3 prose can harden around the selected bars. These three are the complete deterministic fallback under the LLM judge (Ruling 8) — every intake has exactly one bar; the no-key game remains the whole game. Sources: `packages/music/scores/sixthbar-candidates.ts` and `foghorn-song.ts`; renders in `auditions/`.